



INTERNATIONAL FOUNDATION FOR DIGITAL CHILD

Code of Conduct (CoC)

2023



IFDC 

Policy Statement

This Code of Conduct applies to all individuals associated with IFDC, including but not limited to full-time and temporary employees, interns, consultants, independent contractors, and contingent workers. It is mandatory for all personnel to adhere to the principles outlined in this policy, both during and outside of their official duties.

1. Application of the Code of Conduct

1.1 Applicability This Code of Conduct is binding on all personnel affiliated with IFDC, encompassing regular and temporary employees, interns, consultants, independent contractors, and contingent workers, regardless of their employment status or work hours.

1.2 Roles and Responsibilities IFDC's leadership, including the President and CEO, holds central roles as Code of Conduct Focal Points. They have the authority to communicate, enforce, and oversee adherence to IFDC's policies and standards regarding personnel conduct and safety. Administrative and project officers are expected to serve as exemplary role models for other personnel, showcasing acceptable standards of behavior.

1.3 Adhering to Standards of Conduct This Code of Conduct represents the minimum standards for conduct and outlines IFDC's obligations as a development and agricultural organization. In addition to complying with this Code, IFDC employees must adhere to guidelines set forth in the IFDC Office Handbook, Communication Policy, HR documents, and their individual employment contracts. Contingent workers are also required to observe this Code alongside their specific agreements with IFDC.

1.4 Approval and Review This Code of Conduct shall be formally approved by IFDC's Board of Directors and subject to regular review.

1.5 Induction and Annual Training As part of IFDC's mandatory induction process, employees will receive comprehensive briefings on the Code of Conduct and must provide written acknowledgment of their familiarity with and commitment to its principles. Additionally, employees may be obligated to complete annual training programs focused on selected sections of the Code. Contingent workers may also be required to complete induction and agreement processes related to specific provisions.

2. Honesty and Integrity

2.1 Personal Conduct IFDC personnel must consistently demonstrate behavior that aligns with the organization's best interests and upholds the policies and commitments adopted by the Board of Directors.

2.2 Anticorruption Statement IFDC personnel are obligated to uphold and comply with the law, as well as any other applicable requirements, policies, procedures, and standards established by IFDC. Engaging in, facilitating, or benefiting from illegal transactions or activities is strictly prohibited. Personnel charged with or found guilty of a criminal offense must promptly notify the President or CEO.

2.3 Whistleblowing IFDC personnel are encouraged to report any suspicions related to the honesty and integrity of colleagues, contingent workers, vendors, partners, government representatives, or other third parties involved in IFDC's activities. Reporting concerns or violations will not result in retaliation, and disciplinary measures will be taken against those who engage in retaliation or make false reports.

2.4 Drug-Free Workplace The use of illegal drugs or abuse of controlled substances, whether on or off duty, is inconsistent with IFDC's expectations of employee behavior. IFDC personnel must report to work in an acceptable mental and physical condition and are prohibited from using illegal drugs or controlled substances on IFDC premises or during IFDC assignments.

3. Respect and Equality

3.1 Mutual Respect and Prevention of Violence IFDC is a diverse organization that values mutual respect among its personnel. Harassment, discrimination, and violence are strictly prohibited within IFDC's working environment. As IFDC personnel, we endeavor to learn from each other in an atmosphere of positive engagement and mutual respect.

IFDC is committed to promoting workplaces that are free from all forms of harassment, discrimination, and violence, where all individuals are valued, respected, and treated equally and with dignity.

IFDC personnel shall:

- a. Respect and promote fundamental human rights without any discrimination based on social status, race, ethnicity, color, religion, gender, sexual orientation, age, marital status, national origin, political affiliation, or disability.
- b. Treat all colleagues, beneficiaries, affected communities, target groups, and other individuals fairly and with respect, courtesy, dignity, and in accordance with applicable national law, international humanitarian, human rights, refugee laws, and local customs.
- c. Conduct themselves in a non-threatening manner and report any incidents or threats of violence that may affect the workplace.
- d. Uphold the highest standards of accountability, efficiency, competence, integrity, and transparency in the provision of goods and services.
- e. Never abuse their position to withhold assistance, provide preferential treatment, or solicit sexual favors, gifts, payments, or any form of personal advantage. IFDC personnel, particularly in roles related to media development or humanitarian activities, must consciously avoid taking advantage of their position and may not accept gifts, except small tokens of appreciation, or bribes.

3.2 Protection from Sexual Exploitation and Abuse

IFDC works with vulnerable target groups, including women and youth, to promote equitable and sustainable development worldwide. The work ethics of IFDC staff, volunteers, representatives, and partners must align with the organization's values and mission, emphasizing responsibility, respect, honesty, and professional excellence. IFDC does not tolerate harassment, coercion, sexual exploitation, or abuse of any form.

IFDC personnel shall:

- a. Create and maintain an environment that prevents sexual exploitation, abuse of power, and corruption, and promotes the implementation of the Code of Conduct.
- b. Never commit any form of harassment that could result in physical, sexual, or psychological harm or suffering to individuals or beneficiaries, particularly women and children.
- c. Never exploit the vulnerability of any target group, especially women and children, or allow any person to be placed in a compromising situation.
- d. Never engage in any sexual activity with persons under the age of 18, regardless of local laws or customs, as this is strictly prohibited.
- e. Report any incidents of sexual exploitation or abuse involving IFDC personnel or beneficiaries to the appropriate authorities and cooperate fully with any subsequent investigations.

4. Use of IFDC Resources

4.1 Responsible Use of Resources IFDC personnel are entrusted with various resources, including funds, equipment, technology, and information. These resources must be used responsibly and exclusively for authorized IFDC purposes.

4.2 Conflict of Interest IFDC personnel should avoid situations that could present a conflict of interest, whether financial, personal, or otherwise. Any potential conflicts of interest must be disclosed to the appropriate authorities within IFDC, and steps shall be taken to address and mitigate such conflicts.

4.3 Information Security Information security is crucial to IFDC's operations. Personnel must protect confidential information, including but not limited to financial data, employee records, research findings, and partner information. Unauthorized access, disclosure, or use of confidential information is strictly prohibited.

4.4 Resource Conservation IFDC is committed to environmental responsibility. Personnel must endeavor to minimize waste, conserve resources, and follow sustainable practices when carrying out their duties.

5. Compliance with Laws and Regulations

5.1 Local Laws IFDC operates in multiple countries, each with its own set of laws and regulations. Personnel must comply with the laws of the countries in which they work, whether related to immigration, labor, taxes, or any other aspect of their employment.

5.2 IFDC Policies and Procedures In addition to local laws, personnel must adhere to IFDC's internal policies and procedures. These policies provide guidelines on a range of topics, including procurement, travel, security, and ethics.

5.3 Confidentiality of Beneficiary Information IFDC personnel may have access to sensitive beneficiary information. This information must be treated with the utmost confidentiality and used only for the purposes for which it was collected. Unauthorized disclosure of beneficiary information is a breach of trust and may be subject to legal consequences.

6. Reporting Violations

6.1 Reporting Misconduct IFDC encourages personnel to report any violations of this Code of Conduct or other IFDC policies and procedures.

Reports can be made to a supervisor, manager, or the designated IFDC Code of Conduct Focal Points.

6.2 Protection of Whistleblowers IFDC is committed to protecting individuals who report violations in good faith from retaliation. No individual shall be subject to adverse employment actions or other forms of retaliation for reporting misconduct.

6.3 Investigations IFDC will promptly investigate all reports of misconduct and take appropriate action based on the findings of the investigation.

7. Consequences of Violations

7.1 Disciplinary Actions Violations of this Code of Conduct or other IFDC policies and procedures may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment or contractual relationships, as appropriate.

7.2 Legal Action In cases of serious misconduct, IFDC may pursue legal action against the responsible party in accordance with applicable laws.

8. Conclusion

IFDC is dedicated to upholding the highest standards of ethics and conduct among its personnel. The organization relies on the integrity, professionalism, and commitment of its staff and associates to fulfill its mission of promoting sustainable agricultural development. This Code of Conduct provides guidance and expectations for all individuals associated with IFDC to ensure that we collectively achieve our goals with integrity and accountability.